GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

August 21st, 2026
Week 34
Volume 282, Issue 1249

Highlights:

- **Sanctions loom.**
- **Brent nears 94.**
- **Prices leap.**
- **Hulls move.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"In the midst of chaos, there is also opportunity."

- Sun Tzu

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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SANCTIONS LOOM, HULLS MOVE

The war acquired a countdown this week. President Trump announced a sweeping package of economic measures against Iran, described, with characteristic understatement, as an economic D-Day, with Treasury Secretary Bessent confirming that details land Monday. The stated aim is to cut Tehran out of banks, businesses, shipping registries, cash transfers, and smuggling networks, with exposure extending to countries that keep trading with Iran; China, the largest buyer of Iranian crude, has rejected the pressure and called for diplomacy. The UAE, meanwhile, suspended economic ties with Tehran after accusing it of launching missiles at its territory. The blockade holds, the corridor functions, and significant volumes still transit Hormuz. An invasion metaphor with a press schedule: D-Day is Monday, details to follow. For a market that lives downstream of flag states, shipping registries is the phrase worth underlining.

Oil posted a second consecutive weekly gain of roughly 6%, with WTI at USD 87.10 and Brent near USD 93.93 by Friday, the highest since late July, as Ukrainian strikes on Russian refineries and ports deepened fuel shortages inside Russia and reinforced the supply story from a second direction. Urals is up 29% on the month, and last week's unevenly parked shortage has begun redistributing itself: US inventories swung back to a draw after the largest build since January 2023. The barrel, unlike the diplomacy, is making steady progress.

Freight, after four consecutive weekly U-turns, managed a novelty: a drift. The Baltic Dry Index eased from 2,844 to 2,791, touching lows since July 31 at 2,776 midweek before Thursday's 0.5% rebound, as the Capesize index slipped to 4,429 and Panamaxes fell to 2,088, their lowest since July 31. The only segment moving with conviction was the smallest: the Supramax index rose every session to 1,637, its best since July 28. The index remains up 47% on the year, and for recycling the message is quietly constructive: the workhorse sizes closest to the beach are the ones firming.

The data calendar offered nothing and the currencies filled the silence. USD/INR drifted to 95.77, a third week of giving back the spring recovery; the Taka held near 123.50 against the top of its band, with reserves climbing past USD 37.1 billion in a multi-year recovery, the credibility era's second friendly number; the Lira crossed 48 for the first time, closing near 48.07 after a 0.8% Friday slide; and the Pakistani Rupee closed near 277.66, having spent the week appreciating, which, in this basin, qualifies as an act of rebellion. September's prints are the next scheduled facts; Monday's sanctions detail is the unscheduled one.

At the beaches, patience finally converted into movement. FT Island, 43,402 LDT and the basin's largest candidate in months, is now recorded as delivered at Alang, alongside the 11,552 LDT Cutta tanker and the 5,685 LDT reefer Frio Naruto. Chattogram also turned over sharply, with Su Shun delivered and three fresh arrivals, Than, Param and Wantong 498, rebuilding the waterfront ahead of the August 28 to 31 tide. The market beneath them repriced just as decisively. Desk indications leapt roughly USD 50 to 75 across the leaders by Friday, with Gadani vaulting to the top of the board at 515–520 for dry bulk and 535–540 for tankers, the cycle's first Pakistani #1, achieved with an empty beach, and Chattogram close behind at 495–500 and 515–520, its tanker bid still the sharpest edge. India remained uncompetitive for standard tonnage despite plate climbing to INR 40,500, with both rivals maintaining substantial premiums over Alang, though specialist activity continued at strong levels. Gadani's billet famine has turned appetite into pricing power with nothing yet to price. Turkey remained Turkey.

Monday brings the details, the month's end brings the tides, and the waterfront has finally begun to turn over. The market has priced war, peace, corridors, and tolls in turn; it now prices scarcity, and this week it paid up for the privilege. The beaches are moving. The paperwork, as ever, remains the tide that matters.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 34 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

RESERVES UP, WINDOW NEXT

The cushion.

Gross foreign exchange reserves climbed past USD 37.1 billion this week, USD 32.3 billion under the IMF's BPM6 standard, a multi-year recovery that restores comfortable import coverage and hands the credibility era its second friendly number in a fortnight, after July's 8.32% inflation print. USD/BDT held near 123.50, still pressed against the top of its band beneath the February 2025 record of 123.87, and the combination of cooling prices, rebuilding reserves, and a currency that refuses to break its ceiling is, by recent standards, almost boring. The market will take boring.

Between tides.

The August 12 to 15 window closed with the anchorage finally turning over. Su Shun, the LPG tanker that had waited since August 1, is now recorded as delivered, while three fresh candidates arrived this week: the 6,357 LDT Than, 9,520 LDT Param and 1,589 LDT Wantong 498. The anchorage has therefore rebuilt quickly ahead of the August 28 to 31 tide. Demand for mid-to-large units remains robust and breakers continue hunting candidates, though sentiment has cooled a touch from the tanker-rush peak, while local plate held at BDT 64,000 through the week even as vessel-price action ran emphatically higher.

Tankers, still.

The specialist bid that inverted Chattogram's filter a fortnight ago has stopped merely holding and started repricing. Desk indications leapt to USD 495–500 for dry bulk and USD 515–520 for tankers by Friday, roughly USD 50 above last week's board, even as Gadani's tanker bid edged past to take the #1 slot. Appetite for small and mid-sized tankers remains the market's sharpest edge, caution on standard bulkers persists in sentiment if no longer in price, and the spread between the tanker desk and the bulker desk remains the most informative number on the beach. The filter stays flipped; the price board, emphatically, does not stay put.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

The specialist's lane

Rupee drifts.

USD/INR eased to 95.77, a third consecutive week of surrendering the spring recovery, with the Reserve Bank watchful but largely absent from the market. July's 4.45% print, the 19-month high, remains the operative number, the hike conversation it started remains open, and Monday's sanctions detail now hangs over the one flow that has kept Alang busy all summer: if shipping registries are genuinely in Washington's crosshairs, the dark-fleet pipeline is about to get either much busier or much narrower, and nobody on the waterfront claims to know which.

Plate rebounds.

The domestic steel market strengthened through the latter half of the week, with local plate climbing from INR 39,500 to INR 40,500 by Friday and the USD equivalent rising to roughly USD 423. The improvement offers recyclers some support, but with both rivals maintaining substantial premiums over Alang for standard dry and container tonnage, conventional candidates remain difficult for Indian buyers to secure. The steel is moving in the right direction; the competitive gap remains the problem.

Niche, working.

What the standard market withheld, the specialist lane supplied. The 5,685 LDT reefer Frio Naruto is recorded as delivered this week, alongside the 11,552 LDT Cutta tanker and the 43,402 LDT FT Island, the basin's largest candidate in months. The activity extends Alang's franchise in complex, green, and sanctioned tonnage even as conventional pricing remains uncompetitive. The EU List discussions continue, the Statements of Compliance bench remains the deepest in the basin, and the lane stays narrow, but it is Alang's alone.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

THE BID OUTRUNS THE HULLS

Number one, unfed.

Gadani's pocket of stability ended the only way it could: upward. Desk indications leapt to USD 515–520 for dry bulk and USD 535–540 for tankers by Friday, vaulting Pakistan to the top of the sub-continent's board for the first time in the cycle, a #1 achieved, remarkably, with an empty beach. The drivers are unchanged and have simply reached critical mass: an acute famine of Iranian billets, mills leaning ever harder on recyclers for feedstock, and fierce competition for a candidate pool that remains nearly bare. The recently secured units are still in transit. The bid has stopped waiting for them.

Plate firm.

Local plate firmed to PKR 203,000 per ton, near USD 730, the sub-continent's top standing quote, underpinned by the billet shortage and monsoon-season supply friction. The consumption case, housing subsidies, the reduced property withholding tax, post-monsoon construction, is unchanged and intact. The plate has strengthened alongside the vessel board this week. What Gadani awaits is no longer a number; the number arrived. It awaits a hull.

The rebellion.

USD/PKR closed near 277.66, and the story is not that it stayed inside a narrow range; it is that the Rupee spent the week appreciating, firming from 278.20, which in this basin qualifies as an act of open rebellion. The covenant has upgraded itself from stability to strength. With the macro calendar empty until September, Pakistan's waterfront and its inbound candidates remain the only moving parts, and for once the currency is moving in the yards' favour.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

THROUGH 48

The number.

USD/TRY crossed 48 for the first time, closing near 48.07 after a 0.8% Friday move, the milestone arriving in a sanctions week rather than a data week, with the effective overnight rate near 40% still carrying the policy load and the September 10 MPC the next scheduled word. The managed slide has been so orderly for so long that the round number landed almost without comment, which is precisely how the framework prefers its milestones.

The distance.

July's official 31.75% and the Inflation Research Group's 50.49% remain the standing pair until early September's prints, and the roughly 19-point distance between them remains the one Turkish statistic with no volatility whatsoever. The central bank's quarterly report has landed, the forecast has been raised, the Lira has slipped on schedule; the sequence is now familiar enough that only the round numbers register.

Niche, priced.

Aliaga's vessel indications held at USD 262 to 284 per LDT across vessel types, with a thin flow of candidates and a currency that keeps eroding what local buyers can pay. Turkey's franchise remains EU regulation, Basel Convention compliance, and specialist tonnage rather than price, and the watch on the Alang EU List discussions continues from its accustomed distance. Four thousand kilometres east, the surveyors are still at the moat, and the niche, for now, still holds the drawbridge.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 34 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Improving**	515-520 / LDT	535-540 / LDT	545-550 / LDT
2	Bangladesh	**Improving**	495-500 / LDT	515-520 / LDT	525-530 / LDT
3	India	**Softening**	418-423 / LDT	438-443 / LDT	448-453 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	262-264 / LDT	272-274 / LDT	282-284 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *Ship recycling at Alang is estimated to have saved* ***124.5 million barrels of oil****, equivalent to approximately* ***three weeks of India's total oil consumption****.*

- *Recycling ships at Alang is estimated to have avoided the extraction of more than* ***76 million tonnes of iron ore****.*

- *The* ***CO_2 emissions avoided through ship recycling at Alang*** *are equivalent to the annual emissions of more than* ***13 million Indian households****.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 26 - Milad-un-Nabi September 04 – Janmashtami October 02 - Mahatma Gandhi's Birthday	August 26 – September 03 September 08 - September 16

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 26 - Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi September 04 – Janmashtami	August 28 – August 31 September 10 – September 13

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
August 25 – Eid Milad-un-Nabi November 09 – Allama Iqbal Day	August 30 – Victory Day

ALANG - Port Position as of August 21, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Frio Naruto	5,685	Reefer	***Delivered August 19***
2	Cutta	11,552	Oil Tanker	***Delivered August 12***
3	FT Island	43,402	Oil Tanker	***Delivered August 04***

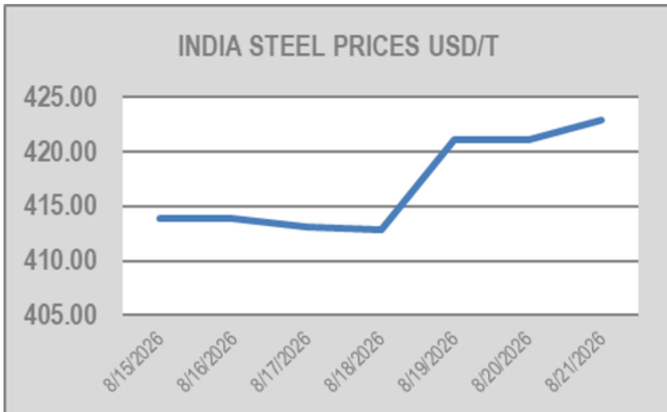
CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of August 21, 2026

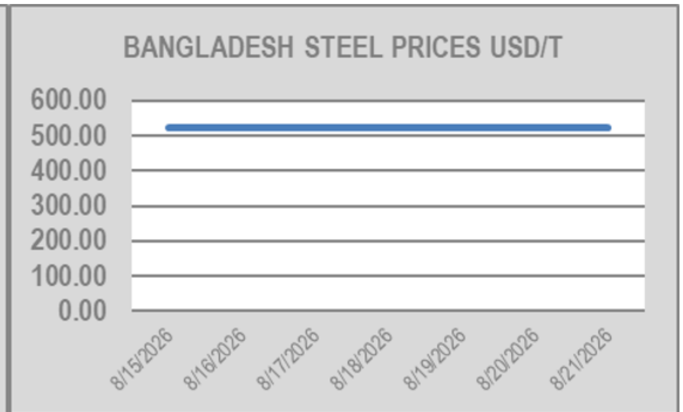
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Than	6,357	Wood Chip Carrier	Arrived August 21
2	Param	9,520	Bulk Carrier	Arrived August 20
3	Wantong 498	1,589	Waste Disposal Vessel	Arrived August 16
4	Su Shun	1,660	LPG Tanker	***Delivered August 10***

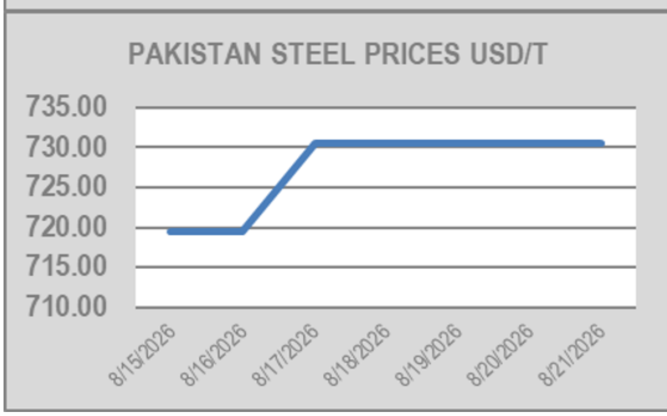
GADANI - Port Position as of August 21, 2026

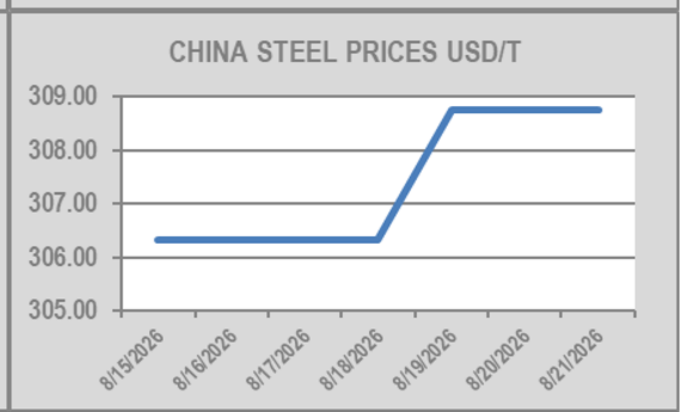
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
No new vessels reported.				

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
8/15/2026	413.92	39,500.00	719.42	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/16/2026	413.92	39,500.00	719.42	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/17/2026	413.14	39,500.00	730.48	203,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/18/2026	412.83	39,500.00	730.48	203,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/19/2026	421.06	40,300.00	730.48	203,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	308.75
8/20/2026	421.06	40,300.00	730.48	203,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	308.75
8/21/2026	422.98	40,500.00	730.48	203,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	308.75









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